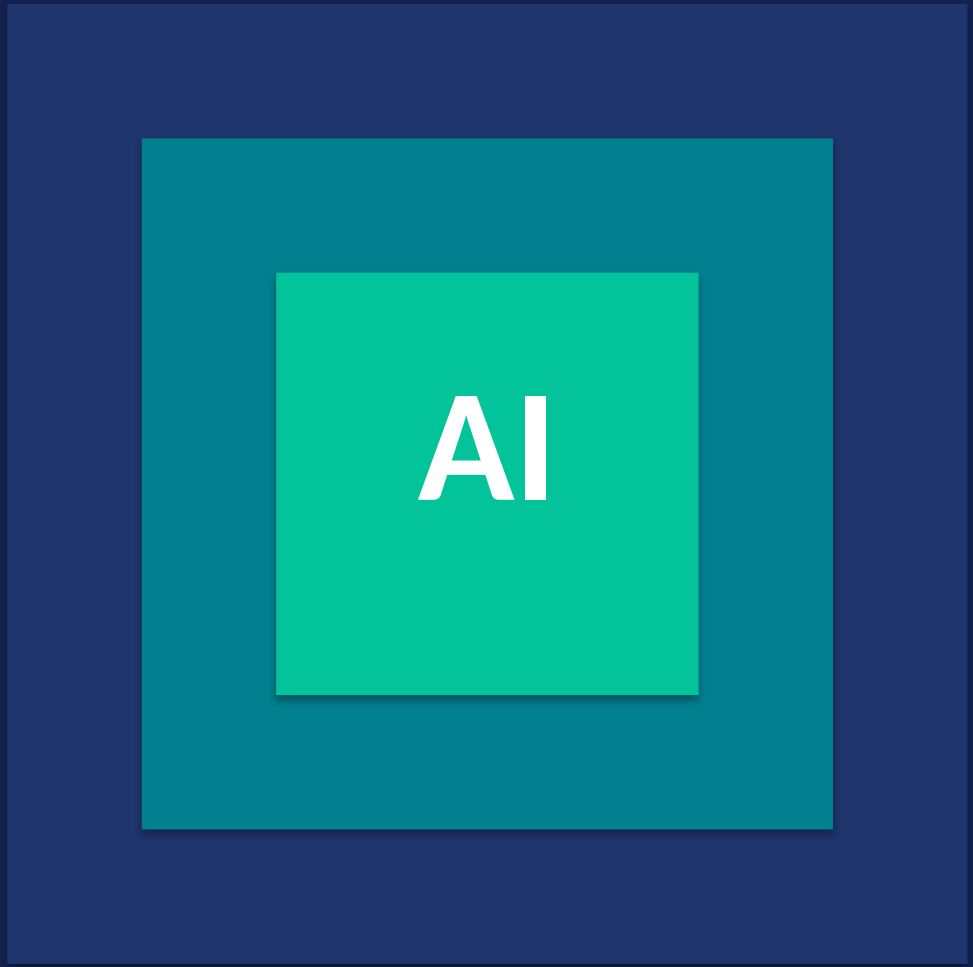
Impact of Artificial Intelligence on the Job Market

Workforce transformation in the age of AI

Thais Granado

Reading College · January 2026



AI is changing how we work

The shift has already begun

AI is transforming tasks, not just jobs

Work is becoming more digital and automated

Adaptation is no longer optional — it is essential

AI reshapes work — not jobs.

The shift is in tasks, not roles

Tasks

Repetitive processes
are automated first

Roles

Roles evolve —
they rarely disappear

Skills

Skills become hybrid:
human + digital

Technology always changes work

History shows adaptation — not replacement

1

Industrial Revolution

Machines replaced manual labour

2

Computers

Digital work replaced paperwork

3

Internet

Global access changed commerce

4

AI Today

Decision support replaces routine thinking

AI is already part of work

"I see AI as a tool that changes how we work — not something that replaces people completely."

- Used daily across industries — from logistics to finance
- Automates repetitive, rule-based tasks at scale
- Supports complex decision-making with data
- Generates content, analyses patterns, predicts outcomes

Some roles are more exposed than others

Higher exposure

- Data entry & processing
- Routine administration
- Basic coding & testing
- Rule-based customer service
- Manual report generation

Lower exposure

- Critical thinking
- Stakeholder management
- Creative problem-solving
- Emotional intelligence
- Governance & oversight

AI replaces patterns — not thinking

Repetition

AI excels at tasks that follow predictable, repeatable patterns

Low judgement

Roles requiring minimal decision-making are most at risk

Structured data

Processes built on rules and structured inputs automate easily

AI also creates new roles

Displacement is real — so is opportunity

AI Trainers

Humans who teach, correct and evaluate AI model outputs

Data Analysts

Professionals who turn raw data into business insight

Governance & Risk

Roles ensuring AI is used ethically and responsibly

Human+AI Hybrid

Specialists who work alongside AI tools for better outcomes

The real shift is in skills

Declining demand

- Repetitive data processing
- Routine administrative tasks
- Manual report generation
- Single-step rule-following

Growing demand

- Critical judgement & reasoning
- Adaptability & continuous learning
- AI literacy & governance
- Human-centred decision-making

Global job transformation — WEF projections

Source: World Economic Forum, Future of Jobs Report

85M+

Jobs displaced

Roles impacted by automation and AI by 2025

97M+

New roles created

Emerging jobs that work alongside technology

50%

Workers need reskilling

Of the global workforce will require significant upskilling

Companies that don't adapt fall behind

Risk: Inaction

- Slow AI adoption
- Poor data decision-making
- Skills gaps in teams
- Increased operational risk
- Loss of competitive edge

Strategy: Adaptation

- Investing in upskilling
- Using AI responsibly
- Integrating AI into processes
- Supporting human judgement
- Building AI governance

AI supports — humans decide.

AI processes

Handles data at speed and scale

Humans interpret

Read context, nuance, and meaning

Humans decide

Take responsibility for outcomes

My perspective on AI

What working with AI has taught me

AI is powerful — but it does not understand context

Confidence in AI output does not mean accuracy

Critical thinking is more valuable, not less

Responsibility for decisions cannot be automated

What I learned

Personal insight from research and practice

Information ≠ Accuracy

AI-generated information can be confident and wrong at the same time. Verification is essential.

Context matters most

AI lacks the lived experience and situational awareness that humans bring to decisions.

Awareness is a skill

Understanding AI limitations makes you more effective — not less relevant.

The future is not

AI vs. humans.

It is:

Humans + AI

working together.

The organisations and individuals who thrive will be those who adapt, learn and lead with judgement.

Key takeaways

AI changes how we work

The shift is in tasks and processes, not the elimination of work itself.

Skills define relevance

Relevance in an AI world comes from adaptability, judgement and continuous learning.

Adaptation is necessary

Organisations and individuals who embrace change will lead — those who don't will fall behind.

Human judgement remains essential

Responsibility, ethics and context-awareness cannot be automated. They remain essential.